



# MESSIAH UNITED METHODIST CHURCH

## CIRCUIT WRITER



**Newsletter Introduction:** *In this month's message, Pastor Johnson invites our church family to celebrate what God is doing among us and to prayerfully step into the next season of spiritual growth, ministry involvement, and shared vision. As we look ahead with faith and expectation, may each of us consider how God is calling us to grow, serve, and participate in the work He is unfolding through our church.*

### A Word from the Pastor: Stepping Forward Together in Faith

Church family, I believe God is doing something beautiful, powerful, and life-giving among us! As I look around our congregation—across generations, cultures, gifts, and stories—I see unmistakable signs of His grace at work. This is a season for us to celebrate what God has already done and to step forward together with fresh faith, joyful expectation, and holy excitement into what He is calling us to become.

Every congregation reaches moments when God invites His people to grow deeper, serve wider, and believe bigger—and I believe this is one of those defining moments for our church. The vision God has given us is not simply about programs, calendars, or plans. It is about transformed lives, strengthened families, renewed passion, neighbors being reached, and our church shining even brighter as a reflection of the kingdom of God.

### Growing Deeper in Christ

As your pastor, I am convinced that spiritual growth is the fuel for everything God is calling us to do. Before we launch new initiatives or take on new assignments, we must first abide in Christ and draw strength from Him. Our wisdom, unity, courage, and joy come from the Lord. As we commit ourselves to prayer, worship, Bible study, discipleship, and daily obedience, God will equip us to carry His mission with bold faith and willing hearts.

For some of us, the next step may be joining a small group, attending Bible study with renewed commitment, or building a stronger prayer life. For others, it may mean mentoring someone younger in the faith, restoring a relationship, welcoming a new family, or finally saying “yes” to gifts that have been waiting to be used. Wherever you are on the journey, I want to encourage you: God is calling each of us to take one faithful, courageous step forward.

### Embracing New Ministry Opportunities

I am excited about the new ministry initiatives before us because they are opportunities to put our faith into action. They are invitations for us to serve, connect, teach, encourage, welcome, and reach beyond our walls with renewed passion. These initiatives are not meant for a select few; they are a shared calling for the whole body of Christ, and there is room for everyone to take part. One of the great blessings of our church family is that we are multigenerational and multicultural. Every voice and every gift matters. Our children remind us of wonder. Our youth bring energy, creativity, and fresh vision. Our adults offer strength, wisdom, and leadership. Our seniors carry testimony, perseverance, and deep spiritual insight. Across cultures and backgrounds, God has placed within us a vibrant variety of experiences that can bless the church, strengthen our witness, and impact the community around us.

## Moving Forward with Shared Vision

The vision God has given our church is bigger than any one person, ministry team, or generation. It calls all of us to pray together, listen together, serve together, and trust God together. As your pastor, my heart is to see us move forward in unity, becoming a powerful living witness of what God can do through surrendered people who are ready to follow where He leads.

There is excitement in the air because this vision is not built on human ambition; it is rooted in faith and carried by the power of God. I believe God is still saving, healing, restoring, teaching, calling, and sending. I believe He has meaningful work for us to do in this season. And I believe that as we grow spiritually and serve faithfully, lives will be changed for His glory.

## An Invitation to Take the Next Step

So I invite each of us to ask with open hearts and ready spirits: What is my next step? Where is God calling me to grow? Where is He calling me to serve? Who is He calling me to encourage, welcome, disciple, or reach?

**This month, I encourage every member of our church family to take one intentional next step: pray about where God is calling you to grow, connect with a ministry leader, join a Bible study or small group, volunteer in a new area of service, or invite someone to worship with you. Let us not only celebrate the vision God has given us—let us participate in it with faith, joy, and commitment.**

Church family, let us move forward with open hearts, willing hands, joyful courage, and expectant faith. The same God who has brought us this far will guide us into what comes next. Together, let us grow deeper in Christ, serve one another in love, and step boldly and joyfully into the vision God has given our church.

*With love, expectation, and faith for what God will do,*

**Rev. Robert L. Johnson**

Welcome Ransford Addae



Ransford Kwabena Addae is a Ghanaian collaborative pianist and music educator currently pursuing an M.S.Ed. in Higher Education at the University of Pennsylvania. He holds a Master of Music in Collaborative Piano from the University of Mississippi and a Bachelor of Arts in Music Education from the University of Education, Winneba. Ransford has collaborated with choirs, vocalists, and instrumentalists in both Ghana and the United States and is passionate about music ministry, education, and developing the next generation of musicians.

## MUMC's Garden and Little Library



**BOTH  
ARE  
DOING  
WELL**



## UPDATES at Messiah



Children's Time w/ Pastor J

# THE FUNPLEX

Saturday, July 18<sup>th</sup> : 1 PM - 5 PM  
3320-24 NJ-38,  
Mount Laurel Township, NJ  
08054

**Ages: 4 - 12**  
NO TRANSPORTATION PROVIDED  
\$20 per person  
\*sign up and pay by July 5th\*

An illustration of a roller coaster with a red track and a yellow car. A yellow ticket with the word 'TICKET' is shown in the top right corner.



**SUMMER MOVIE Night**

"CHARLIE AND THE CHOCOLATE FACTORY"

Get ready for a magical summer movie night under the twinkling stars!

FRIDAY, JULY 24  
OPEN: 7:45 PM  
MOVIE STARTS: AT DUSK

MESSIAH UMC  
527 RIDGE PIKE  
LAFAYETTE HILL

Remember to bring a chair or a blanket. Concessions will be available for purchase.

610-828-0118 WWW.MESSIAHMETHODISTCHURCH.COM



**MESSIAH UNITED METHODIST CHURCH**

# SPONSOR A STUDENT BACKPACK

**JUST \$15 SPONSORS ONE STUDENT**

Your \$15 donation provides a student with a **PREFILLED BACKPACK** with essential items they need to succeed!



Together, we can make a **BIG** difference!

**OTHER WAYS TO DONATE:**

Donations may be made by **CHECK OR MONEY ORDER** payable to Messiah United Methodist Church. Please note "Backpack Drive" in the memo line.

Mail your donation to: **Messiah United Methodist Church**  
527 Ridge Pike  
Lafayette Hill, PA 19444

**DONATION DEADLINE: AUGUST 9, 2026**

**BACKPACK DISTRIBUTION: SATURDAY, AUGUST 22, 2026 1:00 PM – 4:00 PM**

Every backpack. Every supply. Every donation. *Creates opportunity. Changes lives.*

THANK YOU FOR YOUR GENEROSITY AND SUPPORT!



WE GAVE AWAY **80** BACKPACKS.

Thank you so much, to everyone who came out to help.

## Messiah Upcoming Events

# Back to Church Worship & Block Party



**Messiah UMC**

**EVENT DETAILS**

**September 20, 10:30 AM - 3:00 PM**  
**Messiah UMC**  
527 Ridge Pike  
Lafayette Hill, PA 19444  
[www.messiahmethodistchurch.com](http://www.messiahmethodistchurch.com)  
Free event — everyone is welcome!  
Come for worship, stay for fellowship!  
Rev. Robert L. Johnson — Senior Pastor

**MESSIAH UNITED METHODIST CHURCH**

## ANNUAL HEALTH & WELLNESS COMMUNITY DAY

Working Together to Explore Everyday Wellness Habits

**Everyday Wellness Awareness: Habits, Support & Community**

**What to Expect:**

- Health Assessments
- Biometric Screening
- Vaccine Clinic
- CPR Training
- Medication Disposal
- Healthy Living Resources
- Life Coaching
- Moon Bounces
- Face Painting
- Mental Health Resources
- Breast Cancer Resources
- Home Care Services
- Healthcare Training
- Overdose Prevention
- Games and Giveaways
- Music, Food, and Fun
- Stilt Walkers
- Line Dancing

**SEPTEMBER 26, 2026**  
**10:00 AM – 2:00 PM**  
527 Ridge Pike  
Lafayette Hill, PA 19444

Contact Minister Kimberly Charleston  
[messiahumc.events@gmail.com](mailto:messiahumc.events@gmail.com)  
610-828-0118

## More Messiah Upcoming Events



**American Red Cross**



Every 2 seconds, someone in the U.S. needs blood.  
Help save lives.

*Give blood.*

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**Blood Drive**  
**Messiah United Methodist Church**  
**Kolva Hall**

527 Ridge Pike Lafayette Hill, PA 19444  
527 Ridge Pike  
Lafayette Hill, PA 19444

**Tuesday, October 27, 2026**  
**1:00 p.m. to 6:00 p.m.**

Maximize your blood donation. Help more patients. If you are an eligible type O, B - or A - donor, consider making a Power Red donation. Red blood cells are the most commonly transfused blood component.

Please call 1-800-RED CROSS (1-800-733-2767) or visit [RedCrossBlood.org](https://RedCrossBlood.org) and enter: messiah umc to schedule an appointment.

Streamline your donation experience and save up to 15 minutes by visiting [RedCrossBlood.org/RapidPass](https://RedCrossBlood.org/RapidPass) to complete your pre-donation reading and health history questions on the day of your appointment.



Carve out time to give blood 10/19-11/22 for a \$10 Gift Card by email.

1-800-RED CROSS | 1-800-733-2767 | [RedCrossBlood.org](https://RedCrossBlood.org) | Download the Blood Donor App

© 2025 The American National Red Cross | #RED10 Fall 2025



**MARK YOUR CALENDARS**

**FRIDAY, NOVEMBER 13TH**

**AT 6PM**

**FOR**

**MESSIAH'S FAMILY**

**GAME AND MOVIE NIGHT**

## Sunday School at Messiah



Welcome back to Sunday School!

We look forward to seeing our returning students and welcoming new students to our Sunday School classroom when we resume on September 20th.

We will learn about more heroes from the bible, including women who served an important role in spreading God's word and supporting the ministry of Jesus. We will also study topical areas which can support our students as they develop their relationship with Christ.

We learn about the Lord through lessons, scripture reading, activities, games, movies and arts and crafts. Using several different curricula, we create our programming with input from our students and build upon Pastor J's teaching.

Our goal is to connect biblical lessons to the daily experiences of our children.

As always, feel free to join us on any Sunday at 9:45am.

Hope to see you on September 20th.

## Missions at Messiah

### **AS WE CONTINUE TO HELP CNC.**

Colonial Neighborhood Council  
(helping our neighbors in many ways).

ALWAYS NEEDS: non-perishables food items.

### **ITEMS FROM PANTRY WILL BE GOING TO CNC.**

All items may be placed on Mission Hutch in the  
Welcome Center, and we will deliver.

**HELP IS NEEDED FOR DELIVERIES  
PLEASE SEE DALENE.**

### **ALSO HELPING THOSE IN NEED**

**WE ARE ASKING THE CONGREGATION TO PURCHASE \$25 GIANT OR  
TARGET GIFT CARDS FOR THOSE WHO CONTACT THE CHURCH OFFICE  
DURING THE HOLIDAY SEASON.**

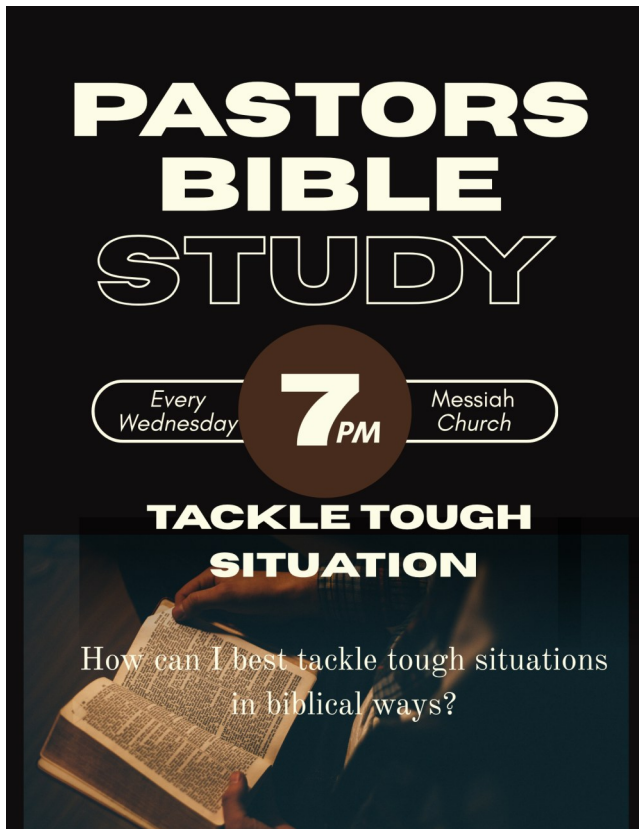
## Bible Studies and Prayer Time at Messiah

**Monday evenings at 6pm for Women in the Word.**

**Wednesday evenings at 7pm is Pastor Bible Study,  
on-line and in-person.**

**WILL RESUME Wednesday, September 16th, 7pm.**

**Monday, Wednesday & Friday evenings, at 7pm, is  
Pastors Prayer time on-line.**



**PASTORS  
BIBLE  
STUDY**

Every Wednesday **7 PM** Messiah Church

**TACKLE TOUGH  
SITUATION**

How can I best tackle tough situations  
in biblical ways?

The poster features a dark background with a central image of hands holding an open Bible. The text is in a bold, sans-serif font, with the title 'PASTORS BIBLE STUDY' in large, white, outlined letters. Below the title, a brown circle contains the text '7 PM'. To the left of the circle is 'Every Wednesday' and to the right is 'Messiah Church'. Below the circle, the text 'TACKLE TOUGH SITUATION' is in bold, white, sans-serif font. At the bottom, the question 'How can I best tackle tough situations in biblical ways?' is written in a smaller, white, sans-serif font.



**PASTOR'S  
PRAYER  
TIME**

A time of prayer to gather our hearts  
and pray to God for all things.

MONDAY, WEDNESDAY & FRIDAY  
EVENINGS AT 7PM ON-LINE

**1 Thessalonians 5:16-18**  
*Rejoice always, pray continually, give  
thanks in all circumstances; for this is  
God's will for you in Christ Jesus.*

 **MESSIAH UM CHURCH**  
[WWW.MESSIAHMETHODISTCHURCH.COM](http://WWW.MESSIAHMETHODISTCHURCH.COM)

The poster has a dark, starry background. The title 'PASTOR'S PRAYER TIME' is in large, white, sans-serif font. Below the title, the text 'A time of prayer to gather our hearts and pray to God for all things.' is in a smaller, white, sans-serif font. Below that, the text 'MONDAY, WEDNESDAY & FRIDAY EVENINGS AT 7PM ON-LINE' is in a smaller, white, sans-serif font. Below that, the text '1 Thessalonians 5:16-18' is in a smaller, white, sans-serif font, followed by the verse text in a smaller, italicized, white, sans-serif font. At the bottom, there is a small white icon of a church building, followed by the text 'MESSIAH UM CHURCH' and the website address 'WWW.MESSIAHMETHODISTCHURCH.COM' in a smaller, white, sans-serif font.

## Women's Book Club

### Women in the Word:

#### Growing in Faith, Fellowship, and God's Word

Women in the Word (WITW) is a ministry of Messiah United Methodist Church created to provide women with a welcoming place to grow in their relationship with God, deepen their understanding of Scripture, and build meaningful relationships with one another. At the heart of the ministry is a simple belief: when women come together around God's Word, we can encourage one another, learn from one another, pray for one another, and grow stronger in our faith.

WITW is more than a Bible study. It is a ministry of faith, fellowship, encouragement, and spiritual growth. Women of all ages and from all walks of life are invited and welcomed. You do not have to be a member of Messiah UMC to participate. Many of our women come from other churches and other denominations. Whether you have studied the Bible for many years, are returning to your faith, are searching for a deeper relationship with God, or are just beginning to explore Scripture, there is a place for you in Women in the Word.

Throughout the year, Women in the Word offers Bible studies, Christian book studies, fellowship gatherings, discussions, and opportunities for prayer and reflection. Our studies are designed to help us connect biblical lessons to the situations women face in everyday life. We talk openly about faith, family, purpose, leadership, relationships, challenges, and what it means to trust God through every season.

One of our studies took us on a journey through the Gospel of John, where we explored the life and ministry of Jesus Christ and reflected on His teachings, miracles, love, sacrifice, and promise of eternal life. Studying John together gave us an opportunity to look more closely at who Jesus is and what it means to truly believe in Him, follow Him, and live out our faith in our everyday lives.

This summer, WITW continues growing together through our Summer Book Club, reading *On Living Stone: Salome's Story* by Heather Kaufman and exploring a faith-inspired story centered on Salome, the mother of the Apostles James and John.

As we continue our journey together, Women in the Word looks forward to studying Corinthians this fall. Through this study, we will continue digging deeper into God's Word and exploring how its teachings can strengthen our faith and guide us in our relationships, our church, our communities, and our everyday lives.

Fellowship is also an important part of Women in the Word. Periodically, we move beyond our virtual gatherings and come together in person for food, conversation, laughter, reflection, and thanksgiving. These gatherings give us an opportunity to strengthen the relationships that develop during our studies and celebrate what God has revealed to us along the way.

One of the beautiful things about WITW is that we do not expect everyone to have the same experiences or the same answers. Our different ages, backgrounds, experiences, and stages of life add richness to our conversations and allow us to learn from one another. We learn by reading Scripture, asking questions, sharing our perspectives, listening to one another, and allowing the Holy Spirit to guide our conversations.

## Women in the Word: cont.

Our goal is for every woman who participates to leave encouraged to open her Bible more often, pray more confidently, recognize God's presence in her daily life, discover her gifts, and walk more boldly in the purpose God has given her.

Women in the Word is about women supporting women while keeping Christ and His Word at the center.

As Scripture reminds us: "For where two or three gather in my name, there am I with them."  
Matthew 18:20 (NIV)

Whether we gather around a table, meet through Zoom, share a meal, discuss a book, pray together, or simply listen to another woman's testimony, we believe God is present and working among us.

Women in the Word is a journey and there is always room for another woman to join us. Come as you are. Come study. Come fellowship. Come grow. Come discover what God is speaking through His Word.

Kimberly Charleston, CSM

**MESSIAH UMC**  
**Women in the Word**  
**SUMMER BOOKCLUB**

HEATHER KAUFMAN  
*On LIVING STONE*  
SALOME'S STORY  
NARRATED BY RACHEL BOTCHAN

Join Women in the Word this summer as we journey through  
"On Living Stone—Salome's Story" by Heather Kaufman—a  
powerful biblical fiction that invites us to experience a journey of  
faith inspired by the story of Salome, mother of the Apostles James  
and John. Let's grow in God's Word together as we explore her story.

**Women's Fellowship and Book Review**  
**Sat Oct 3, 2026 at Messiah UMC**  
For info, contact Kim Charleston, CSM  
messiahumc.events@gmail.com

| <b>Sept.<br/>Dates</b> | <b>Worship<br/>Leader</b> | <b>Usher/<br/>Greeter</b> | <b>Hospitality<br/>Host</b> | <b>Counter</b>     |
|------------------------|---------------------------|---------------------------|-----------------------------|--------------------|
| <b>9/6</b>             | <b>Please<br/>Sign-up</b> | Ben & Team                | <b>Please<br/>Sign-up</b>   | Sandi<br>Smith     |
| <b>9/13</b>            | <b>Please<br/>Sign-up</b> | Ben & Team                | <b>Please<br/>Sign-up</b>   | Sandi<br>Smith     |
| <b>9/20</b>            | <b>Please<br/>Sign-up</b> | Ben & Team                | <b>Back to<br/>Church</b>   | Frank<br>Sylvester |
| <b>9/27</b>            | <b>Please<br/>Sign-up</b> | Ben & Team                | <b>Please<br/>Sign-up</b>   | Sandi<br>Smith     |

**PLEASE PRAYER AND CONSIDER HELPING OUR WORSHIP  
EXPERIENCE, BY SIGNING UP TO BE A WORSHIP LEADER  
AND FOR  
HOSPITALITY TO ENJOY FELLOWSHIP TIME AFTER WORSHIP.**

| <b>Oct.<br/>Dates</b> | <b>Worship<br/>Leader</b> | <b>Usher/<br/>Greeter</b> | <b>Hospitality<br/>Host</b>    | <b>Counter</b>     |
|-----------------------|---------------------------|---------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------|
| <b>10/4</b>           | <b>Please<br/>Sign-up</b> | Ben & Team                | <b>Please<br/>Sign-up</b>      | Sandi<br>Smith     |
| <b>10/11</b>          | <b>Please<br/>Sign-up</b> | Ben & Team                | <b>Pastor<br/>Appreciation</b> | Sandi<br>Smith     |
| <b>10/18</b>          | <b>Please<br/>Sign-up</b> | Ben & Team                | <b>Please<br/>Sign-up</b>      | Frank<br>Sylvester |
| <b>10/25</b>          | <b>Please<br/>Sign-up</b> | Ben & Team                | <b>Please<br/>Sign-up</b>      | Sandi<br>Smith     |

## MESSIAH CALENDAR

Sept. PASTOR'S HOT TOPICS

### SEPTEMBER 13th—RETURN TO 10:30AM WORSHIP SERVICE

- Sept. 16th Pastor's Wed. evening, Bible Study resumes
- Sept. 20th Sunday School resumes
- Sept. 20th Back to Church/Block Party **WEAR YOUR MUMC SHIRTS**
- Sept. 26th Health & Wellness Day at Messiah, See Kim Charleston**
- Sept. 25th WHAM—Candle decorating, 7pm, in Kolva Hall, see Patty
- Sept. 27th Kid Konnection resumes, after Children's Time w/Pastor
- Oct. 3rd WitW Summer Book Fellowship & Review, 11am
- Oct. 10th Women at the Well—Small Grp. BS at 10am
- Oct. 11th Pastor Appreciation Sunday
- Oct. 17th Vision Team Meeting
- Oct. 24th Chicken BBQ Dinner, 4-7pm
- Nov. 3rd Voting at Messiah, office closed
- Nov. 13th Fall Family Game & Movie Night, 6PM**
- Nov. 18th Charge Conference, SPRC 6:30pm & 7:00pm Congregation w/ Brad Light in-person at MUMC

### Sunday Mornings:

**REGULAR** worship beings on September 13th back to 10:30am

**Nursery** - for ages newborn to 4 yrs. old. **LOOKING FOR HELP WHEN NEEDED**

**Sunday School** - Sunday mornings, ages 5-10 at 9:45am—**See you in the Fall**

**Youth** - meets on 4th Sundays

**Kid Konnection** – 2nd & 4th Sundays, ages 5-10 after children's time w/Pastor -

**See you in the Fall**

**Children's Time** - is with the Pastor during worship

**Masks are optional in the church building during worship,**

**if you feel the need, masks are available by back door.**

Worship will continue to be streamed live on Facebook and YouTube.

Recordings of past services are on Website, Facebook and YouTube.



## We Support Our World With:

**THESE ARE OUR PRAYERS—LORD HEAR OUR PRAYERERS  
PLEASE HELP THE OFFICE KEEP THIS PRAYERER LIST UP TO DATE.**

### LORD HEAR OUR PRAYERERS

**JOY:** **Steve Fischer** (Lori Lorenz brother) cancer free.

**PRAYERS:** All those effected by the extreme weather, **Amy** (Dave B. co-worker) lost boyfriend in garage collapse, **Rene Anderson, Alan & Carol, Berni** (friend of Barbara Stone) undergoing chemotherapy, **Bob** (Laura Nester's Dad) moving to retirement community, **Cam Smith** travel mercies, **Debbie** (friend of K&L Walters) very sick/rehad., **Carole E.** (friend of Dalene) continued prayers, **Tammy Edwards** (friend of D. Carroll) continued prayers, **Kate Fabio** (friend of Mindy) double mastectomy surgery, **Kim G.** (friend of Y. Calvin) prayers for her care of father, **Patty G** (friend of Barbara Stone) surgery for throat cancer, **Lily Margaret Gross, Hannah** (friend of Dalene) continued prayers, **Jasmine Harris** (niece of R. McGee) awaiting double lung transplant, **Adam Hearlson** (friend of D. Barbay) spine cancer, **Michelle Hepburn's Grandmother, Hunt Family, Kendal** (friend of Plummrs) brain tumor, now complications, **All those who suffer with metal illness, Maryanne & Kristen** (friends of Nester's) comfort and healing, **Mark** (friend of L&K Walters) recurrent lung cancer, **Maurice,** (friend of the Johnson family), **Michael McGee** (Roslyn brother) stage 4 cancer, **Mike** (friend of Dalene) continued prayers, **Laura** (friend of Plummer) breast cancer treatment, **Harry LaBelle** (Dalene's Ex-husband) recovering, needs stint surgery, **Lori LaBelle** continued prayers, **David Loften** (friend of Teddy), **Joan Livingston** (works w/Heidi) esophageal cancer, had surgery, doing well, **Avery Patrick** heart problems, **Kevin Patterson** (Y. Cahur) starts chemo, **Khalir Redd,** in a car crash, broken hand, bruised and sore, **Robbie** (nephew of B. Stone) cancer surgery, **Roseann & Joe** (friends of Dalene) continued prayers, **Keith Schoolfield** pancreatic cancer, **Mary Sowell** in hosp., **Jon Stemler** (friend of Belford's) colon cancer, **Harold Thompson** (friend of Teddy), **Irma Ward Walker, Bishop Raymond K&L Walters** (niece Angie, passing of 19 yr. old son), **Natalie Webb** stroke & heart, **Ava Westfield** (friend of Roslyn McGee) murder of nephew, **Wilson Family** difficult times, **Mary Wismer** still doing chemo, but doing well, **John Wynne** (friend of Dave B.) melanoma, **Bill Young** (friend of Dalene) continued prayers.

### Messiah's Birthdays

IF YOU DON'T SEE SOMEONE, PLEASE LET THE OFFICE KNOW

#### SEPTEMBER BIRTHDAYS

04-Lafayette Charleston  
08-Julia Basmajian  
19-Vincent Oandasan  
19-Lena Oandasan  
20-Coulton Moser  
20-Mary Wismer  
25-Louis Oandasan  
26-Melanie Bertram  
27-Emily Plummer



#### OCTOBER BIRTHDAYS

01-George Lare  
03-Elsie Friedgen  
09-Frank Sylvester  
12-Courtney Kershaw  
14-Jacob Amberg  
20-Mark Rooney

## Financial Corner

### 2026 Member Plans-for Giving numbers (as of 7/31/26):

2026 Budgeted Amount: \$176,500 (Last year was \$163,000)  
Pro-Rata Budgeted Amount: \$101,827  
2026 Actual Amount Collected: \$ 67,005 (Last year at \$72,333)



### 2026 Profit/Loss (as of 7/31/26):

Total Income: \$ 92,118  
Total Expenses: \$152,521  
Net Income: -\$ 60,403

All paid up on apportionment

Respectfully Submitted,  
Ho Chang

## Trustees Page



The Trustees are still working hard to keep our building and property clean and safe. We want to give a special THANKS to Kent Barbay and Kevin Walters for all the lawn care, Lord has blessed us with so much, and it is a large task to maintain our property and we thank them for doing so week after week. The fall season is here and

The Trustees also thank Phil and Charlie for their hard work around our building, scraping and repainting the front doors of the church and fixing the ramp on the shed, adding new non-slip strips, so NO MORE SLIPPING!!!!

## **A View from the Hill: Updates from Messiah UMC**

In a spirit of openness and shared ministry, we offer this edition of *A View from the Hill* as a window into current projects, leadership goals, and important happenings around Messiah UMC. In each issue, we hope to share the good news, the challenges before us, and the work we are called to do together as we care for God's house and the community entrusted to us.

### **Facilities Update**

In this issue, our attention turns to the current state of our facilities. The Board of Trustees has been faithfully caring for our buildings and property. As many of us know, the size and age of our facilities bring challenges that call for patience, prayerful planning, and faithful stewardship.

### **Parsonage Repair**

This summer, we encountered a significant challenge at the parsonage. An unexpected maintenance issue arose when the sewer pipe running beneath the foundation collapsed. The old terra-cotta pipe had to be replaced at a cost of \$10,000 so we could continue caring responsibly for the home and for those living there.

We are deeply grateful to Mr. Frank Sylvester, who served as the liaison between the church and the tenants. Frank secured Roto-Rooter to address the pipe damage and related construction work, including digging up part of the old foundation, installing a new pipe, and helping ensure the tenants' safety. We are blessed to have reserves available to complete this repair, and anyone who would like to support this effort with a monetary gift is welcome to do so. Such gifts will help us avoid drawing down reserves used for ongoing maintenance. We are also thankful for the patience and cooperation of the tenants who gave us the time needed to secure the contractor and complete the work. Carpet in one area of the parsonage will also need to be replaced as part of our commitment to their safety, comfort, and well-being.

### **Front Entrance and Drainage Project**

In the near future, infrastructure work will take place at the front of our church. The township and its project partners will complete major drainage system improvements along the front of the property. While this work may bring some inconvenience, especially as office staff and others enter and leave the parking lot during the week, it is an important improvement that will serve the area well.

Messiah is blessed to receive compensation for the work affecting our front entrance and exit. The township will reimburse the church \$17,000 for the five-foot portion of church property needed for the drainage project. The Board of Trustees has not yet decided how those funds will be used and welcomes thoughtful ideas from the congregation.

I also want to offer sincere thanks to Steve Lorenz and all members of the Board of Trustees for their steady and faithful leadership on the many ongoing projects in the life of our church. Serving as a trustee is not an easy ministry, and we give thanks for those who offer their time, wisdom, and gifts in service to God's house.

### **Building Security**

We are also giving prayerful attention to building security. Messiah is blessed with a church property located on the hill here in Whitemarsh Township, and it is important that this place remains welcoming and safe for all who enter. Conversations continue about how we can better secure our buildings and care for everyone who comes onto the property.

Plans are underway to make our buildings more secure, help us better monitor building access by renters and members, and protect sensitive areas of the facility. We will work to secure better door-closing mechanisms, so doors close tightly and securely as people move in and out of the building.

cont.

We will also establish access points that reduce the need for every group to have keys, helping us maintain greater accountability for who is in the building and at what time. In addition, we will update our rental and lease agreements, so they reflect current needs and are easier to use. We also hope to make it possible for applications to be completed online and for electronic payments to be processed. These are just a few of the security and administrative improvements being proposed as we continue working to make our property safer, more welcoming, and better prepared for the ministries that happen here.

## Reflection

Scripture reminds us, “Unless the Lord builds the house, those who build it labor in vain” (Psalm 127:1). As we tend to pipes, parking lots, doors, and decisions, we remember that this work is not only about maintaining buildings; it is about preparing a place where people may encounter God’s grace, find welcome, and join in the ministry of Christ. May our care for this property reflect our deeper calling to care for one another.

### Questions You May Have:

#### **What happened at the parsonage?**

An unexpected maintenance issue arose when the sewer pipe beneath the foundation collapsed. The old terra-cotta pipe was replaced at a cost of \$10,000 so the church could continue caring responsibly for the home and those living there.

#### **What additional parsonage work remains?**

Carpet in one affected area still needs to be replaced as part of the church’s commitment to the tenants’ safety, comfort, and well-being.

#### **What work will happen at the front entrance?**

The township and its project partners will complete drainage system improvements along the front of the church property. Some inconvenience may occur as people enter and leave the parking lot during the week.

#### **What is the \$17,000 reimbursement for?**

The township will reimburse Messiah \$17,000 for the five-foot portion of church property needed for the drainage project. The Board of Trustees has not yet decided how those funds will be used.

#### **How can members share ideas about the reimbursement funds?**

Members are invited to put questions, comments, or ideas in writing and share them with any member of the Board of Trustees.

#### **What security improvements are being planned?**

Proposed improvements include stronger door-closing mechanisms, designated access points that reduce the need for keys, better accountability for building access, updated rental and lease agreements, online applications, and electronic payment options. These changes are intended to strengthen security while keeping Messiah welcoming and ready for ministry.

#### **Questions and Feedback**

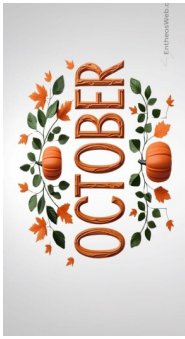
If you have questions, comments, or ideas—especially about the use of the \$17,000 reimbursement—please put them in writing and share them with any member of the Board of Trustees. Your voice matters as we continue growing together and caring for the administrative and physical needs of our church. This has been *A View from the Hill*. May we continue looking from this hill with gratitude, hope, and trust in the One who guides our way.



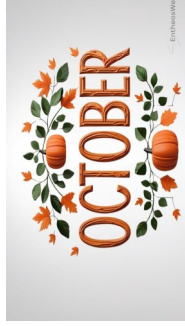
# September 2026



| Sunday                                                                                                                                                       | Monday                                                               | Tuesday | Wednesday                  | Thursday | Friday                        | Saturday                           |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|----------------------------|----------|-------------------------------|------------------------------------|
| <b>Sunday Mornings:</b><br>Sunday School, begin Sept. 20th, 9:45am<br>Regular Worship, begins Sept. 13th, 10:30am                                            |                                                                      |         |                            |          |                               |                                    |
|                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                      | 1       | 2-<br>Prayer Time<br>w/ PJ | 3        | 4-<br>Prayer<br>Time w/<br>PJ | 5                                  |
| <b>6-Communion Sunday</b><br>Worship Leader: Kim Charleston<br>Greeters: Ben & Team<br>Counters: Frank Sylvester<br>Hospitality Hosts: Please sign-up        | 7-<br>6pm WitW,<br>Book Club w/<br>Kim Charleston<br>Prayer Time w/  | 8       | 9<br>Prayer Time<br>w/ PJ  | 10       | 11<br>Prayer<br>Time w/<br>PJ | 12                                 |
| <b>13-10:30 am Worship begins</b><br><b>Trustees Meeting after worship</b><br>Worship Leader: Kim Charleston<br>Greeters: Ben & Team<br>Counter: Sandi Smith | 14-<br>6pm WitW,<br>Book Club w/<br>Kim Charleston<br>Prayer Time w/ | 15      | 16<br>Prayer Time<br>w/ PJ | 17       | 18<br>Prayer<br>Time w/<br>PJ | 19-<br>HOMELESS<br>OUTREACH        |
| <b>20- Back to Church-Block Party</b><br>Worship Leader: Please sign-up<br>Greeters: Ben & Team<br>Counter: Sandi Smith<br>Hospitality Hosts: Please sign-up | 21-<br>6pm WitW,<br>Book Club w/<br>Kim Charleston<br>Prayer Time w/ | 22      | 23<br>Prayer Time<br>w/ PJ | 24       | 25<br>Prayer<br>Time w/<br>PJ | 26-<br>Health &<br>Wellness<br>Day |
| <b>27</b><br>Worship Leader: Please sign-up<br>Greeters: Ben & Team<br>Counter: Sandi Smith<br>Hospitality Hosts: Please sign-up                             | 28-<br>6pm WitW,<br>Book Club w/<br>Kim Charleston<br>Prayer Time w/ | 29      | 30<br>Prayer Time<br>w/ PJ | 31       |                               |                                    |



# October 2026



| Sunday                                                                                                                                                           | Monday                                                                 | Tuesday                              | Wednesday                  | Thursday | Friday                        | Saturday                               |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|----------------------------|----------|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| <b>Sunday Mornings:</b><br>Sunday School, 9:45am<br>Regular Worship at 10:30am                                                                                   |                                                                        |                                      |                            | 1        | 2-<br>Prayer<br>Time<br>w/ PJ | 3-<br>Women in<br>the Word<br>Luncheon |
| <b>4-Communion Sunday</b><br>Worship Leader: Kim Charleston<br>Greeters: Ben & Team<br>Counters: Sandi Smith<br>Hospitality Hosts: Please sign-up                | 5-<br>6pm WitW,<br>Book Club w/Kim<br>Charleston<br>Prayer Time w/ PJ  | 6                                    | 7<br>Prayer<br>Time w/ PJ  | 8        | 9<br>Prayer<br>Time w/ PJ     | 10                                     |
| <b>11-Trustees Meeting after worship</b><br>Worship Leader: Kim Charleston<br>Greeters: Ben & Team<br>Counters: Sandi Smith<br>Hospitality Hosts: Please sign-up | 12-<br>6pm WitW,<br>Book Club w/Kim<br>Charleston<br>Prayer Time w/ PJ | 13-<br>Leadership<br>Meeting,<br>7pm | 14<br>Prayer<br>Time w/ PJ | 15       | 16<br>Prayer<br>Time w/ PJ    | 17-<br>HOMELESS<br>OUTREACH            |
| <b>18-</b><br>Worship Leader: Please sign-up<br>Greeters: Ben & Team<br>Counters: Frank Sylvester<br>Hospitality Hosts: Please sign-up                           | 19-<br>6pm WitW,<br>Book Club w/Kim<br>Charleston<br>Prayer Time w/ PJ | 20                                   | 21<br>Prayer<br>Time w/ PJ | 22       | 23<br>Prayer<br>Time w/ PJ    | 24-<br>CHICKEN<br>BBQ<br>DINNER        |
| <b>25-</b><br>Worship Leader: Please sign-up<br>Greeters: Ben & Team<br>Counters: Sandi Smith<br>Hospitality Hosts: Please sign-up                               | 26-<br>6pm WitW,<br>Book Club w/Kim<br>Charleston<br>Prayer Time w/ PJ | 27-<br>Blood<br>Drive                | 28<br>Prayer<br>Time w/ PJ | 29       | 30<br>Prayer<br>Time w/ PJ    | 31                                     |
|                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                        |                                      |                            |          |                               |                                        |

# MESSIAH UNITED METHODIST CHURCH



**Messiah United Methodist Church**  
**527 Ridge Pike**  
**Lafayette Hill, PA 19444**

*(Church office hours are Mon.—Fri., 8:00am—11:30am)*

Church Office: 610-828-0118, Church Fax: 610-828-2463

Church email: [messiahchurch@verizon.net](mailto:messiahchurch@verizon.net)

Pastor email: [revrlj1@gmail.com](mailto:revrlj1@gmail.com)

Website: [www.messiahmethodistchurch.com](http://www.messiahmethodistchurch.com)

Pastor: Rev. Robert L. Johnson  
Music Director: Ransford Addae  
Choir Director: Kristen Moser  
Admin. Assistant: Mary Basmajian  
Nursery Attendant:  
Sexton: John Basmajian



If you have an article or announcement about yourself, your family, or church activities for a future issue of The Circuit Writer, please submit it to the church office, via email/US mail or hard copy in bin on door of office, by no later than the **15th** of the month. If you have changes of address, phone, or email, please help us communicate with you better, by sending the church office these updates via email or phone.

## **Our Mission Statement:**

It is our mission to win people to Christ,  
train believers to become disciples, and send  
disciples to impact the world.

Our mission and vision serve as the  
foundation for all ministries and guide every  
decision, program, and interaction within  
Messiah UMC.

**Our Vision Statement:**  
**Messiah UMC,**  
**A place**  
**where faith**  
**and**  
**real life connect**

Messiah United Methodist Church  
527 Ridge Pike  
Lafayette Hill, PA 19444

PLEASE  
PLACE  
STAMP  
HERE

**Sent with a Prayer to:**